

Salvation

The lyrics of "Salvation" paint a vivid image of the darkness that often accompanies addiction. Elton John's powerful vocals and heartfelt delivery bring to life the pain and despair experienced by those dealing with their demons. The raw emotions conveyed in the song create a sense of empathy, allowing listeners to connect with the struggles portrayed.

I have to say, my friends,
this road goes a long, long way,
and if we're going to find the end
we're gonna need a helping hand.

I have to say, my friends,
we're looking for a light ahead.
In the distance a candle burns
salvation keeps the hungry children fed.

It's gotta take a lot of salvation,
what we need are willing hands,
you must feel the sweat in your eyes,
you must understand, salvation.

A chance to put the devil down
without the fear of hell.
Salvation spreads the gospel round,
and free you from yourself.

Slave

Elton John's "Slave" is written from the perspective of a man who has been taken into slavery and is dealing with the horrors. It takes all his will to keep from fighting back as he awaits the "war that's yet to come," most likely a reference to the American Civil War.

There's a river running sweat right through our land,
driven by a man with a bullwhip in his hand
and I've taken just as much as I can stand.
Oh, we've got to free our brothers from their shackles if we can.

Most nights I have to watch my woman cry,
every day I watch the colonel smile,
his painted ladies riding in from town.
I swear one day I'm gonna burn that whore house to the ground.

Slave! Slave!
To fight the violence we must brave,
hold on strong
to the love God gave, slave.

There's a rumour of a war that's yet to come
that may free our families and our sons,
it may lay green lands to barren wastes,
the price of release is a bitter blow to face.

Amy

The lyrics of Amy dive into the complexities of love and loss, portraying the emotional rollercoaster of a failed relationship. Through soulful melodies and poignant lyrics, Elton John brings to light the pain and bittersweet memories associated with a lost love. The song evokes a sense of longing, regret, and nostalgia, drawing listeners into its melancholic journey.

Tread on my face if you like, little lady,
turn me inside out if you have to baby,
but don't you cross me off your list.
I am young and I ain't never been kissed,
never been kissed, by a lady called Amy.

You're far out, you're fab and insane,
a woman of the world it's quite plain.
My dad told me Amy's your name,
said he'd break my neck if I played your game,
but he can bust my neck, 'cause I love you all the same.

Amy, I know you don't have to show your affection,
'cause the big boys like you, and to you I'm an infection.
So if you don't want me around,
I think I'll run along and drown,
you can't want this bum in town, Amy.

I'm beaten on the streets 'cause I loves you,
I watch you go to work in the summer,
I don't whistle at you down the street—
I would if I could, but I can't whistle you see.

Amy, I may not be James Dean,
Amy, I may not be nineteen,
and I may still be in romper boots and jeans,
but Amy, you're the girl that wrecks my dreams.

Mona Lisas and Mad Hatters

The lyrics of Mona Lisas and Mad Hatters are an ode to the people who are invisible to society, yet they make up the heartbeat of the city. John paints a picture of a city that is both magical and gritty. Through his lyrics, he acknowledges the harsh reality of the city's marginalized communities, its distinctive culture, and the beauty of its people.

And now I know, Spanish Harlem
are not just pretty words to say.
I thought I knew,
but now I know that rose trees never grow
in New York city.

Until you've seen this trash-can dream come true,
you stand at the edge while people run you through
and I thank the Lord there's people out there like you.

While Mona Lisas and Mad Hatters,
sons of bankers, sons of lawyers,
turn around and say good morning to the night,
for unless they see the sky,
but they can't, and that is why
they know not if it's dark outside or light.

This Broadway's got a lot of songs to sing,
if I knew the tunes, I might join in.
I'll go my way alone,
grow my own, my own seeds shall be sown
in New York city.

Subway's no way for a good man to go down,
rich man can ride, and the hobo he can drown,
and I thank the Lord for the people I have found.

Hercules

Sometimes you just need a happy, it really doesn't have any meaning but to have fun song! It's been a long week, fraught with some unexpected health concerns, so I am desperately in need of de-stressing and having some fun. And this song, Hercules, is nothing if not fun!

Ooh, I got a busted wing
and a hornet sting
like an out of tune guitar,
Oh, she got Hercules on her side
and Diana in her eyes.

Some men like the Chinese life,
some men kneel and pray.
Well, I like women
and I like wine
and I've always liked it that way,
always liked it that way.

But I can't dig it,
the way she leaze
that old tough man routine up her sleeve,
livin' and a 'lovin', kissin' and a huggin',
livin and a lovin with a cat named Hercules.

Oh, and it hurts like hell.
to see my gal
messin' with a muscle boy,
no superman gonna nun my plans
playin' with my toys.

Rich man sweatin' in a sauna bath,
poor boy scrubbin' in a tub,
me, I stay gritty up to my ears,
washing in a bucket of mud,
washing in a bucket of mud.

Stonky Château

Elton John

Side Two

Original album published in 1972 by DJM Records Limited.
design by zjncoc © 2024

dedicated to us, eternal youngsters.

Honky Château

Elton John

Side One

The whole concept of the album Honky Château is based on the transition from youth to maturity, accompanied by all realizations and problems along the way.

Lyrics by Bernie Taupin & Elton John

Piano Elton John
Bass Dee Murray
Guitar and banjo Davey Johnstone
Drums Nigel Olsson

I think I'm going to kill myself

The meaning behind the song is intense and thought-provoking. It explores the depths of despair and the desperate feeling of wanting to end one's life. Elton John, along with his songwriting partner Bernie Taupin, crafted poignant lyrics that capture the darkness and desperation of someone who feels trapped and devoid of hope. The song serves as a powerful depiction of the internal struggle and pain experienced by individuals who contemplate suicide.

I'm getting bored
being part of mankind,
there's not a lot to do no more,
this race is a waste of time.

People rushing everywhere,
swarming round like flies,
think I'll buy a forty-four,
give 'em all a surprise.

Think I'm gonna kill myself,
cause a little suicide,
stick around for a couple of days,
what a scandal if I died.

Yea, I'm gonna kill myself,
get a little headline news.
I'd like to see what the papers say
on the state of teenage blues.

A rift in my family,
I can't use the car,
I gotta be in by ten o'clock,
---who do they think they are?

I'd make an exception
if you want to save my life,
Brigitte Bardot gotta come
and see me every night.

Honky Cat

The lyrics of Honky Cat may sound fun and entertaining, but a closer look reveals a lot more depth. The song chronicles the life of a man who has left the country and moved to the city. The protagonist is meant to represent John himself, who had recently moved to California from his home country, England.

When I look back,
boy, I must have been green,
boppin' in the country,
fishin' in a stream.

Lookin' for an answer,
tryin' to find a sign,
until I saw your city lights,
honey, I was blind.

They said, get back, Honky Cat,
better get back to the woods,
well, I quit those days and my redneck ways,
and oh, oh, oh, the change is gonna do me good.

You better get back, Honky Cat,
livin' in the city ain't where it's at.
It's like tryin' to find gold in a silver mine,
it's like tryin' to drink whisky from a bottle of wine.

Well I read some books, and I read some magazines
about these high class ladies
down in New Orleans,
and all the folks back home said I was a fool,
they said, believe in the Lord,
is the golden rule.

They said stay at home, boy, you gotta tend the farm,
livin' in the city, boy,
is gonna break your heart.
But how can you stay, when your heart says no,
how can you stop,
when your feet say go.

Susie

The overall theme of the song centers around the protagonist's infatuation with a mysterious and captivating woman named Susie. Through the vivid lyrics and energetic melody, Elton John paints a picture of a whimsical relationship that defies societal norms.

I got frostbitten in the winter
ice skating on the river
with my pretty little black-eyed girl.
She'd make your darn toes curl
just to see her.

I got a fringe front on my buggy,
I got a frisky little cat in a hurry
and a pretty little black-eyed Susie by my side.

Well she sure knows how to use me
pretty little black-eyed Susie,
playing hooky with my heart all the time.
Living with her funky family
in a derelict old alley
down by the river where we share a little lovin' in the moonshine.

I'm an old hayseed harp player,
I'm the hit of the county fair
with my pretty little black-eyed girl,
living proof as she swirls,
she's a dancer.

Mellow

The song's meaning revolves around the concept of finding peace and solace within oneself. It delves into the struggles and challenges that individuals face in their pursuit of happiness and contentment. The lyrics beautifully convey a sense of longing for tranquility and a desire to escape from the chaos and complexities of the world.

Coal grass blowin' up the pass, don't you know I'm feeling mellow.
I love your Roman nose, the way you curl your toes,
baby, makes me feel so mellow.

It's the same old feelin' I get when you're stealin'
back into my bed again,
with the curtains closed and the window froze
by the rhythm of the rain.

You make me mellow you make me mellow,
rockin' smooth and slow,
mellow's the feeling that we get
watchin' the cool fire glow.

You make me mellow, I make you mellow,
wreckin' the sheets real fine,
Heaven knows what you sent me Lord,
But God this is a mellow time.

Going down to the stores in town gettin' all the things we need,
don't forget the beer, my little dear,
it helps to sow the mellow seed.

And it can't be bad,
all the love I've had
coursin' through my life,
down in the pass
where the wind blows fast
and mellow's a feelin' right.

Rocket Man

The lyrics of Rocket Man tell the story of an astronaut in orbit, far from his family. The song also suggests the spread of drug use during the 70s, connected with a sense of loss, meaningless concept of time and disconnection from reality, popular especially among the younger generation.

She packed my bags last night
pre-flight,
zero hour, nine a.m.
and I'm gonna be high as a kite by then.

I miss the earth so much,
I miss my wife,
It's lonely out in space
on such a timeless flight.

And I think it's gonna be a long, long time
till touch-down brings me round again to find
I'm not the man they think I am at home.
Oh, no, no, no,
I'm a rocket man,
rocket man burning out his fuse up here alone.

Mars ain't the kind of place to raise your kids,
in fact it's cold as hell
and there's no one there to raise them if you did.

And all this science,
I don't understand
It's just my job, five days a week,
a rocket man.